

	EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES AGENCY	POLICY NUMBER	714
	A Division of the Merced County Department of Public Health	Effective Date	11/2025
Authority: Health and Safety Code, Division 2.5, and California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Division 9, Chapter 4, 1797.220		Initial Date:	07/2022
		Review Date:	01/2028

RESPIRATORY DISTRESS	
ADULT	PEDIATRIC
BLS	
Assess Vitals / Obtain SpO ₂ / Oxygen - Titrate to SpO ₂ of 94% or higher / Secure Airway - Assist Ventilations if needed.	
CPAP – Moderate / Severe Distress. EMT Optional Scope – <u>For Patients Presenting with Severe Asthma:</u> Epinephrine 1:1,000 Adult Auto-Injector IM OR 0.3 mg IM (0.3 ml) via approved syringe	CPAP – Moderate / Severe Distress. EMT Optional Scope – <u>For Patients Presenting with Severe Asthma:</u> Epinephrine 1:1,000 Pediatric Auto-Injector IM OR 0.15 mg IM (0.15 ml) via approved syringe
ALS	
Follow BLS procedures if applicable. Obtain 4-Lead ECG. Vascular Access – As appropriate for patient condition. Capnography – For Moderate / Severe Distress.	
Asthma / COPD	
Mild Distress: Albuterol - 2.5 mg via Nebulizer May repeat 2.5 – 5 mg for continued distress	
Moderate / Severe Distress: CPAP Albuterol - 5 mg via Nebulizer/CPAP/BVM - May repeat 2.5 – 5 mg for continued distress Magnesium Sulfate - 2 gms in 10 ml, slow IVP over 2 minutes - May repeat once after 5 minutes for continued distress	Moderate / Severe Distress: CPAP Albuterol - 5 mg via Nebulizer/CPAP/BVM May repeat 5 mg for continued distress

Signatures on File

Approved By: Tim Williams
EMS Administrator

Ajinder Singh, MD
EMS Medical Director

For continued distress following above treatment:

Epinephrine 1:1,000 – 0.01 mg/kg IM, max dose 0.5 mg

- May repeat after 20 minutes for continued distress

For continued distress following above treatment:

Epinephrine 1:1,000 – 0.01 mg/kg IM, max dose 0.3 mg

- May repeat after 10 minutes for continued distress

CHF / Pulmonary Edema

Mild Distress:

Nitroglycerine - 0.4 mg SL

- May repeat every 5 minutes if SBP > 100 mmHg

Moderate / Severe Distress:

CPAP

Nitroglycerine

- SBP 100 – 150 mmHg = **0.4 mg SL**
- SBP 150 – 200 mmHg = **0.8 mg SL**
- SBP > 200 mmHg = **1.2 mg SL**

Nitroglycerine Paste

- SBP 100 – 120 mmHg = **1 inch**
- SBP > 120 mmHg = **2 inches**
- Remove if SBP < 100 mmHg

Patients with SBP < 90 mmHg AND Pulmonary Edema:

Push Dose Epinephrine - 10mcg slow IV/IO (10mcg/ml)

- Repeat every 1-5 minutes until SBP is > 90mmHg

No Standing Orders

Suspected Croup / Epiglottitis with Severe Inspiratory Stridor

No Standing Orders

Nebulized Epinephrine

- 0.3 mg (3 ml) 1:10,000, **OR**
- 0.3 mg (0.3 ml) 1:1,000 diluted with 2.7 ml NS (for a total 3 ml combined dose)

Base Hospital Physician Orders Only

Contact Base Hospital before administering Nitroglycerin to patients taking Viagra (Sildenafil) or similar erectile dysfunction drugs within the past six (6) hours.